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C A R I B B E A N E X A M I N A T I O N S C O U N C I L

**SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE
EXAMINATION**

ENGLISH B

Paper 01 – General Proficiency

1 hour 45 minutes

11 MAY 2011 (p.m.)

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

- 1. This paper consists of THREE questions.**
- 2. Answer ALL questions.**
- 3. Begin EACH question on a new page.**
- 4. Each question is worth 15 marks.**
- 5. You should use 15 minutes of the time allowed to read through the entire paper.**

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.



ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS IN THIS PAPER.

SECTION A – DRAMA

1. Read the following extract carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

Scene 2 – It is evening.

Erma sits in an armchair with the table lamp off. HAROLD appears in the doorway and peers into the room.

HAROLD: Erma, you here?

ERMA: I here.

- 5 *Harold enters and turns on the light.*

HAROLD: Why not turn on the light? The bill's paid up.

ERMA: I thinking.

HAROLD: Light never stopped anyone from thinking ... You want to see me? You'll have to make it quick. My flight leaves in two hours.

- 10 ERMA: You won't be going on that flight.

HAROLD: I thought we went over that before. I made it patently clear that this is a business trip and I am going alone.

ERMA: Don't talk high and mighty to me, Harold. It isn't me that's causing you to cancel your trip.

- 15 HAROLD: Who else but you would look for an excuse to keep me in this pen?

ERMA: Ask Sonia.

- 20 HAROLD: Why? What's going on here? You threw a tantrum this morning because I had a few drinks last night. All that weepy, soppy stuff about staying home and talking to you. Now I'm talking to you, you won't even spare me an explanation. What's this about Sonia? I noticed neither of you ate supper. One of your silent battles?

ERMA: I ain't fighting no battle. [*Stands.*] Sonia pregnant, Harold.

Harold stands still, rooted by shock.

HAROLD: I must be hearing things. Say that again.

- 25 ERMA: Sonia pregnant. I make her tell me while you been eating. [*Silence.*] She pregnant. I know from this morning.
- HAROLD: And didn't say anything? What kind of mother are you?
- ERMA: I was too sick to say anything.
- HAROLD: Pregnant. Can't be. [*Going to the door and shouting*] Sonia! Sonia, I want to see you right now! [*Crosses to the bar and pours a drink.*]
- 30 ERMA: That won't help.

Sonia comes in cautiously, as if expecting a blow.

Material from 'Woman Take Two' by Telcine Turner (c) Telcine Turner 1987,
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- (a) (i) What might the stage direction, '**Erma** sits in an armchair with the table lamp off' (line 1) suggest about Erma's state of mind? (1 mark)
- (ii) Give ONE reason for your response in (a) (i) above. (1 mark)
- (b) From lines 15 – 17, Harold's speeches start mainly with questions.
- (i) What does this suggest about the relationship between Erma and him? (2 marks)
- (ii) Give TWO words that describe Harold's tone in these lines. (2 marks)
- (c) Explain TWO ways that Erma builds up suspense in lines 7 – 20. (4 marks)
- (d) What is the effect of the stage direction, '**Sonia** comes in cautiously, as if expecting a blow' (line 31)? (2 marks)
- (e) Suggest a title for the extract and say why you chose this title. (3 marks)

Total 15 marks

SECTION B – POETRY

2. Read the following poem carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

There's Been a Death in the Opposite House

There's been a death in the opposite house
As lately as today.
I know it by the numb look
Such houses have alway.

5 The neighbours rustle in and out,
The doctor drives away.
A window opens like a pod,
Abrupt, mechanically;

10 Somebody flings a mattress out, -
The children hurry by;
They wonder if it died on that, -
I used to when a boy.

15 The minister goes stiffly in
As if the house were his,
And he owned all the mourners now,
And little boys besides;

20 And then the milliner,¹ and the man
Of the appalling² trade,
To take the measure of the house.
There'll be that dark parade

Of tassels³ and of coaches⁴ soon;
It's easy as a sign, -
The intuition⁵ of the news
In just a country town.

*Emily Dickinson, "There's Been a Death in the Opposite House".
In Selected Poems, 1993, pp.16 – 17.*

¹A milliner is a hat-maker.

²Appalling means dreadful or horrible.

³Tassels refers to streamers or ribbons.

⁴Coaches are carriages drawn by horses.

⁵'Intuition' means hint.

- (a) Identify TWO signs from lines 1 – 8, by which the speaker knows that somebody has died in the opposite house. **(2 marks)**
- (b) Select ONE image from lines 7 – 9 and comment on its effectiveness. **(3 marks)**
- (c) (i) What impression of the minister is created in the lines, “The minister goes stiffly in... mourners now” (lines 13 – 15)? **(1 mark)**
- (ii) Using evidence from lines 9 – 20, explain TWO ways in which the poet conveys a sense of something horrible taking place. **(4 marks)**
- (d) State TWO things that make the poem easy to listen to or memorise. **(2 marks)**
- (e) What do lines 17 – 24 tell you about the speaker’s feeling? Give evidence to support your answer. **(3 marks)**

Total 15 marks

SECTION C – PROSE FICTION

3. Read the following extract carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

We found Rygin with Mr Johnson, somewhere downstream where the river runs just behind the White Marl cemetery, where there was more grass than trees. And the banks were lined with water-lilies and tall water grass with large corn-like flowers blowing gently. There also, the river was wide as two main roads and shallow enough in some parts for its complexion to move from washed-out sand to the green of the leaves with a little sun in it. And in places, one could see the water slither across the bed of stones and schools of perch dart in and out of the reeds. And one could slide through the water-lilies and be in the water before you could say *Red Head*.

Mr Johnson was a large man of serious demeanour with tight, dark skin that gleamed in the sunlight – rich, my mother said, from eating so much fish. He lived three houses down the road from me. I had not expected to see him. He was my mother’s friend. His son Andrew, was mine. He wanted to know why we were not in school.

“We on half-day,” Spragga said. I kept very quiet.

“Half-day no.” He was in the middle of the water. Rygin was at the bank closest to us. They were in the middle of a routine unfamiliar to me. Mr Johnson worked the net across the river in a straight line as Rygin twisted his hands expertly.

He paused at the half-day remark. “Andrew never tell me nothing ’bout that this morning.”

“Not Andrew class,” Patrick added quickly, “but our class.”

“Then Wesley,” Mr Johnson said wisely, attending once more to his net, “you and Andrew not in the same class again?”

“Yes, Mr Johnson.”

“Is scull¹ the bwai them scull school.” Rygin joined the conversation. “Nothing more than the boy them scull class.

“Sculling school not a good thing,” Mr Johnson said, looking at me.

Adapted from Garfield Ellis, For Nothing At All, Macmillan, 2005, pp. 38 – 39.

¹scull means to skip school

- (a) (i) What mood is created by the description of the setting in paragraph 1? **(1 mark)**
- (ii) How does the writer create the mood identified in (a) (i) above? **(2 marks)**
- (b) How does the sentence, 'I had not expected to see him' (lines 9 – 10) introduce a shift in the mood of the passage? **(2 marks)**
- (c) Identify ONE feature of the passage which suggests that it is set in the Caribbean. **(1 mark)**
- (d) Explain TWO ways that the writer builds tension in the passage. **(4 marks)**
- (e) (i) Give ONE reason why the narrator's response to Mr Johnson is different from that of his friend. **(2 marks)**
- (ii) How does Mr Johnson's behaviour make the passage humorous? **(3 marks)**

Total 15 marks**END OF TEST**

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